

Develop and Demonstrate Loyalty: The EQ Wacky Stack, Featuring Joan Cronan

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There is no doubt you have a high IQ. If you didn't, you wouldn't be watching these videos. But IQ doesn't equal EQ – your emotional quotient, or emotional intelligence.

Emotional intelligence plays an enormous role in these dynamics, and simply put, emotional intelligence is being aware of how you come across to others and your willingness and ability to adjust.

Now, there is a right way to build emotional intelligence and there is a wrong way.

Let's start with the right way. There are four building blocks to emotional intelligence, and they need to be stacked in a particular order.

It starts with you understanding yourself. Pat (Summitt) started by taking a personality profile and analyzing its insight. She took it a step further and insisted that all members of the team – her coaches, her players, her assistants, and staff – took that personality profile test as well. I even took one.

Secondly, use that knowledge to better manage yourself. Having the information about yourself doesn't matter if you aren't using it to manage yourself better. Right?

Thirdly, focus on understanding others. You know your strengths, your tendencies, and now you (can) become a student of others' strengths and tendencies.

Then fourthly, a final block is to manage the relationships.

Pat always individualized her approach with players based on how they best responded to her feedback. Some players needed to be yelled at, while others needed to be quietly pulled to the side for a calm chat.

But here is how many of us have stacked the blocks in the past. We start off correctly with self-awareness but then we jump right in to relationship management.

Whoops! That's not working.

There's often negative friction and misunderstanding. So we backtrack and then try to understand the other person.

If you want to grow your emotional intelligence, better manage your relationships, and come across in the right way, focus on understanding and managing yourself first.